

# Preston Probst

(630) 853-6260 | pjamesprobst@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/prestonpro | github.com/pjprobst

## EDUCATION

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### University of Pittsburgh

Expected Graduation: 2028

*Bachelor of Science in Computer Science, Minor in Philosophy*

*Pittsburgh, PA*

- *Coursework:* Data Structures & Algorithms, Assembly Language & Computer Organization, Discrete Structures, Formal Methods in Computer Science

## EXPERIENCE

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### Character.AI

May 2026 – Present

*Software Engineer Intern*

*Redwood City, CA*

- Shipped a cross-platform subscription sale, driving \$414K in new-subscriber revenue in its first 12 days and a 10% lift in subscription starts by building platform-specific subscription and offer-code redemption flows in Go + React.
- Built in-chat ads, generating \$150K+ monthly revenue by styling a GAM ad unit with CSS and rendering in React.
- Implemented a value-exchange system, demonstrating a \$500K+ increase in monthly revenue in experimentation by building a state machine in TypeScript to let users watch a long-form video ad for a break from interstitial ads.
- Deployed a brand-safety filter, blocking ads on 150K+ unsafe searches/day by classifying queries before ad serving.

### Iris (YC F25)

Sep. 2025 – Jan. 2026

*Software Engineer Intern*

*Remote*

- Co-built the MVP for an AI assistant presented at YC Demo Day, supporting a \$2.5M pre-seed raise, by creating a tool-calling agent and React Native app for iOS and Android with AWS Fargate, FastAPI, Redis, and PostgreSQL.
- Reduced system-prompt tokens by ~35% while retaining agent performance by writing test cases and developing evals in Python with a mock MCP server and an LLM-as-a-judge to score nondeterministic results.
- Integrated Google Calendar + Gmail MCPs and built support for custom integrations within a multi-LLM stack.
- Shipped real-time notifications, boosting engagement by ~15% with GCP Pub/Sub, FastAPI, and React Native.

### DME Elevators & Lifts

July 2025 – Aug. 2025

*Software Engineer Intern*

*Lisle, IL*

- Redesigned webpages, increasing monthly form fills by 150% and driving a 2-year high in web-generated leads by modernizing pages in React and building an interactive Leaflet.js map to visualize location and installation data.

### Ruddervirt

Sep. 2024 – Jan. 2025

*Software Engineer Intern*

*Remote*

- Created a dashboard for a virtual-machine-based cyber course serving 444K+ students using Svelte/PostgreSQL.

## PROJECTS

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### DentalConnect, *SteelHacks XII Winner* | React, FastAPI, MongoDB, Auth0, AWS, Python

- Fine-tuned a CNN image model on 10K+ images in AWS SageMaker to detect oral diseases with 87% accuracy.
- Developed a patient/dentist portal with location-based search, saved dental analyses, and upcoming appointments.

### Smart Fridge Module | ESP32, C, libcurl, SQLite, Python, Raspberry Pi

- Connected a touchscreen and barcode scanner to an ESP32 so users could log food and index unrecognized items.
- Engineered a C/libcurl client and Raspberry Pi API for HTTP lookups across a 4M+ record SQLite database.

### Offline India, *Illinois Global Scholar Recipient* | React, Node.js, Service Workers, IndexedDB, Cache API, Leaflet

- Launched an offline-first site with locally cached emergency resources and maps for internet shutdowns in India.
- Researched internet shutdowns in India alongside local experts to inform user experience and design decisions.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

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**Languages:** JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, Python, Go, Java, C, HTML, CSS

**Libraries/Frameworks:** React, React Native, Svelte, Node.js, Flask, FastAPI, PyTorch, Playwright, pandas, NumPy

**Databases:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite, Redis

**Developer Tools:** Git, Docker, GCP, AWS, REST APIs, Auth0, MCP, Linux/Unix, Statsig, Amplitude, CI/CD